

August 12, 2026

Cigna Healthcare
Cigna Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 188011
Chattanooga, TN 37422

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Randall Stroman (MRN MUSC0249450), Claim MUSC-20251021-8F43-3

Patient	Randall Stroman (DOB 1956-10-18)
MRN	MUSC0249450
Member ID / Group	CIG204429254 / GRP-30566
Claim number	MUSC-20251021-8F43-3
Date of service	2025-10-21
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$470.84
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2026-06-03

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this first-level appeal on behalf of patient Randall Stroman (MRN: MUSC2600955, Member ID: CIG204429254, Group: GRP-30566) regarding Claim ID MUSC-20251021-8F43-3 for services rendered on October 21, 2025, at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687). Cigna Healthcare denied the claim in full on December 5, 2025, citing CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115 ("This decision was based on a Local Coverage Determination (LCD)"), with the additional payer remark that "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." The billed amount of \$470.84 remains unpaid. MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests a full reversal and payment at the allowed amount of \$311.75.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Stroman is a 69-year-old male with a well-documented, longitudinal history of care at MUSC Health. His active problem list includes hyperlipidemia, anemia, prediabetes, rheumatoid arthritis, and chronic sinusitis — a constellation of chronic conditions that collectively require ongoing clinical monitoring and management. He carries a documented history of recurrent upper respiratory illness, including prior episodes of acute viral pharyngitis and viral sinusitis. He is a former smoker and is currently managed with Simvastatin 10 mg for hyperlipidemia. The October 21, 2025, encounter was billed under the primary diagnosis of J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified), a clinically appropriate code given his established history of recurrent upper respiratory conditions and the active diagnosis of chronic sinusitis, which shares the same ICD-10 designation of J06.9 and has been present since 1979.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of CPT 99214 for this established-patient office visit is not supported by the clinical record. CPT 99214 reflects an office or outpatient visit of moderate complexity for an established patient, and its selection is consistent with the documented complexity of Mr. Stroman's care. A 69-year-old patient managing multiple active chronic conditions — including rheumatoid arthritis, prediabetes, anemia, and hyperlipidemia — who presents with an acute upper respiratory complaint requires evaluation that accounts for the interaction of those comorbidities with the acute presentation. The treating physician, Dr. Lindqvist, is responsible for assessing whether the acute illness exacerbates or is complicated by the patient's underlying conditions, and that clinical judgment appropriately supports a moderate-complexity level of service.

Cigna's reliance on a Local Coverage Determination to deny medical necessity for an acute upper respiratory visit in a patient of this complexity is misplaced. J06.9 is a widely recognized, payable diagnosis, and the visit type and place of service — an established-patient encounter at an on-campus outpatient hospital facility — are entirely consistent with the billed code. The payer's assertion that documentation does not establish medical necessity does not account for the totality of the patient's active conditions, which are part of the longitudinal medical record and directly relevant to the clinical decision-making involved in this encounter.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Cigna Healthcare conduct a thorough review of the complete medical record for this encounter, including Mr. Stroman's active problem list and medication history, and reverse the denial in full. We request that payment be issued at the previously established allowed amount of \$311.75 in accordance with the terms of the Cigna Healthcare Choice Plus plan. Should Cigna require additional clinical documentation to complete this review, please contact MUSC Health's Revenue Cycle Appeals team promptly so that records may be provided within the applicable timeframe. This appeal is being submitted in advance of the June 3, 2026, appeal deadline via the designated portal as required.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record